

Calibrating The Scanner

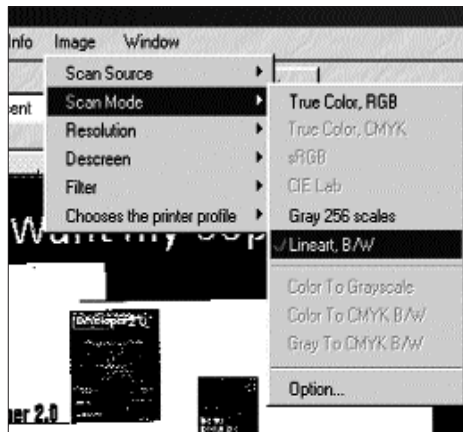
Calibrate your scanner every one or two months for optimum results. Calibration involves scanning a known colour and adjusting the output to match that colour. In case the scanner doesn't support calibration, get a standard gray (RGB=128, 128, 128) reference colour card from a photo lab, and scan the image along with it. Open it in Photoshop and press [I] to activate the Eyedropper tool. The Info Palette shows the RGB values as you move the mouse pointer over the colour card. If it matches with the actual colour (RGB = 128, 128, 128 in this case), your image colours are perfect. Otherwise, change the colour balance and brightness of the image until you get the precise reference colour. Finally, crop out the scanned reference colour card.

Scanning Magazines

Scans of magazines or newspapers often result in dotted image patterns, commonly referred to as moiré. Minimise this effect by scanning the image at 300 dpi with the scanner software's Descreen filter on, and then re-sizing it to 33 per cent of its size using photo-editing software such as Photoshop. Finally, apply the Unsharp Mask filter.

Scanning Line-art

Line-art is a clip art, drawing or pencil sketch, consisting of two colours. There are three methods of scanning line-art. The first is the Black and White Mode, or 1-bit scanning that just picks up the black areas. This method suits line-art that does not have shades akin to that of pencil sketches as it keeps the image size to the minimum. Remember to re-size



Use the Line-art mode in the scanner software to scan Line-arts